SHOOTING STARS FOUNDATION

GLOBAL KICK-OFF | 17th OCTOBER 2026

IBM Z Datathon

Global Hackathon Event for College Students

Hosted by Shooting Stars Foundation | Powered by IBM



Attendance Form:
https://forms.gle/hxTYwzJRqgwnWaPn8

SHOOTING STARS FOUNDATION

Datathon Day 1 Agenda



01	Intro to Shooting Stars Foundation
02	IBM Z Datathon
03	Reflection: Pre-Datathon Events
04	Meet Your IBM Z SMEs
05	Meet the SSF Volunteers
06	Keynote
07	Participant TO-DO list
08	Datathon Begins

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Datathon Prizes Overview – Each Region

First Prize	$1000
Second Prize	$750
Third Prize	$500

WINNERS ALSO RECEIVE

- IBM Z Day Feature: Teams showcased at the annual global celebration
- 6 month IBM Z access

SHOOTING STARS FOUNDATION

Datathon Prizes Overview – Each Campus

First Prize — **$1000**

Second Prize — **$750**

Third Prize — **$500**

WINNERS ALSO RECEIVE

- **IBM Z Day Feature: Teams showcased at the annual global celebration**
- **6 month IBM Z access**
- **Opportunity to visit IBM Campus***

**Depending on presence of local labs and upon availability of slots*

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IBM Z Datathon

Hosted by Shooting Stars Foundation | Powered by IBM

DATATHON DATE
October 17th–18th, 2026

DATATHON THEME
AI For Good

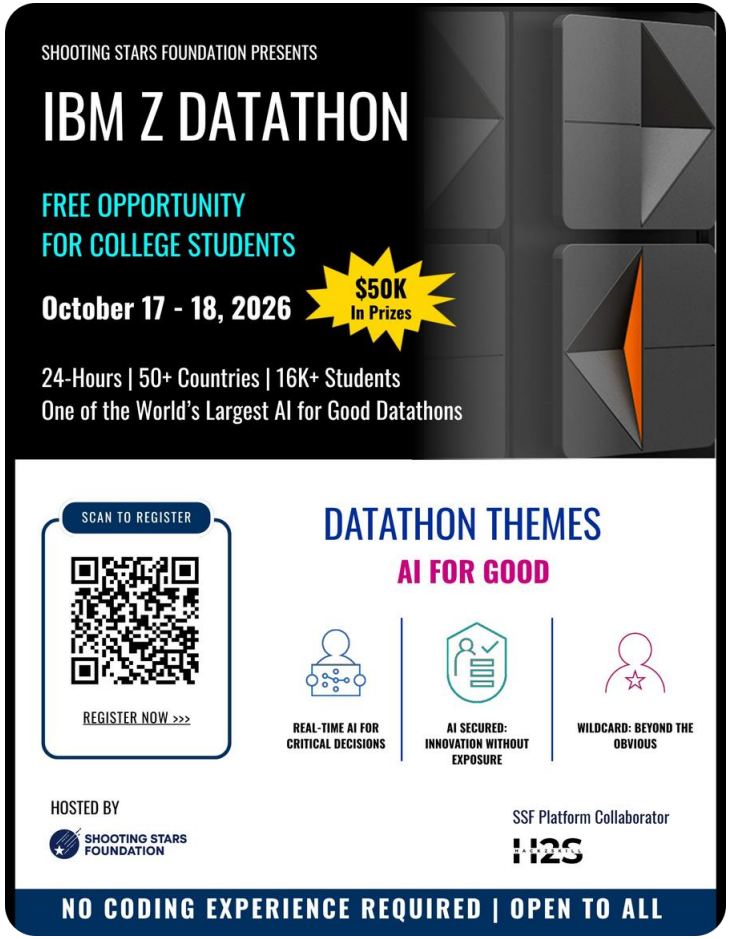
TEAM SIZE
4–6 members per team

PRIZES
Cash Prizes – Three Categories

TECHNOLOGY
Open to All

IN-PERSON VENUES

- Saveetha College, Chennai
- GAT College, Bangalore
- University of Manchester, London
- Federation University, Australia
- Nanyang Technological University, Singapore
- Cyberjaya University, Malaysia
- New York University, USA
- University of Texas at Dallas, USA



SHOOTING STARS FOUNDATION

Pre-Event Sessions

01 Welcome & What to Expect Kickoff

Speaker: Shooting Stars Foundation and IBM team

02 IBM Z & LinuxONE 101

Speaker: Lucas Sahn, IBM Z NA Skills Leader

03 Team Formation & Project Ideation Workshop

Speaker: Shooting Stars Foundation team

04 Theme Deep Dive – Trust & Identity

Speaker: Sadie Revercomb, IBM Z and LinuxONE Security Product Manager, zNext

05 Theme Deep Dive – AI on IBM Z

Speaker: Anastasiia Didkovska, Product Manager, AI for z/OS, Steve Warren, STSM & Principal Z Solution Architect, and Moritz M, Software Engineer, z/OS Data Gatherer

06 IBM Z Datathon: How to Win Workshop

Speaker: Joe Winchester – STSM, Zowe.org | Open Mainframe Project Ambassador | Master Inventor

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IBM Z SMEs for the 2026 Datathon

Our IBM Z experts are here to help you build – find them on #ibm-z-sme-helpdesk.


Abraham Varghese


Adam Ring


Ajit Samuel John


Akash Nayak


Alex Osadchyy


Amit Mishra


Amiya Dixit


Aravind Thalachil


Arshan D Shwaruf


Ashish Agarwal


Ashish Sahoo


Athil Gafoor


Basavaraj Mathapaty


Ben Davis


Bradley Snyder


Brandon Somoza


Bruce Gilkes


Choon Yean Ng


Clayton Slaughter


Darren Ng


Davion Thompson


Devonte Hawkins


Divya K Konoor


Eshan Chury


Ganeshi Shreya


Gautam Siwach


Gokul Krishnan G


James Greene

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Jayarani Kumar


Jianbin Tang


Joe Winchester


John Diamond


Jurgen Holtz


Justice Heughan


Jwala Kottapalli


Khairul Nizam Abd Razak


Lewis James


Lucas Sahn


Manoj S Pattabhiraman


Mariyana Dimitrova


Mark Dudding


Matt Wakeham


Mehmet Cuneyt Goksu


Milandeep Shergill


Mrudula Prashanth


Nafeez Nasser


Nasser Ebrahim


Paul Novak


Nihar Ranjan Panda


Nur Shahida Muhtar


Pabitra Mukhopadhyay


Ravi Kumar


Phila Dlamini


Phillip Wilson


Pooja Dave

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Saipriya M


Sandeep Ambekar


Saurabh Srivastava


Shalawn King


Shruthip Venkatesh


Sowmya Kameswaran


Srinivas Bhat V


Sunil Mishra


Suresh Panara


Sushmita Senmajumdar


Syed Mohammad Mansoor


Tyler Asiyo


Valerie Spencer


Varun Upadhyaya


Venelin Kabakov


Vineet Dumir


Vishal Gupta


Vishwas R


Vivek Mankar


Yadu Nandan B


Yevgen Karpenko

SHOOTING STARS FOUNDATION

Global Kickoff Keynote Speakers



KEYNOTE SPEAKERS

Adam LG Ring

IBM Z & LinuxONE Ecosystem/Skills Leader APAC and Global Head IBM Z Startups (+AI) community

IBM Z Datathon 2026 • Global Kick-off

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Participant To-Do List

01 While You Build

- Choose one theme: Real-Time AI for Critical Decisions, AI Secured: Innovation Without Exposure, or Wildcard
- Write all your code during the event window. Pre-built projects are not allowed.
- Save screenshots of your LinuxONE instance and platform capabilities you use (containers, security, compute) – judges look for this evidence.
- Keep a list of every open-source library /resource you use; link them in the project.
- Use #ibm-z-sme-helpdesk for technical questions (open on event day) and #helpdesk for everything else.

02 Required for Final Submission

- A demo video of 3 minutes or less covering the problem, supporting data, your solution and how it uses IBM Z (tech stack, LinuxONE instance, model)
- A GitHub/GitLab link or Link of a zip file of your project
- A pitch deck PDF in the format [Team Name]_IBM Z Datathon 2026 Project
- Links to all open-source resources used

03 Optional but Recommended

- A solution flowchart or architecture diagram
- A working prototype

04 Final Checks

- Watch the submission video guide beforehand
- Submit early, not in the last minutes
- Join the Closing Ceremony at 10:30 AM on Oct 18

05 Throughout the Event

- Keep competition friendly and avoid hateful or politically-inclined projects
- Report any code-of-conduct issue to an SSF organizer

06 After the Datathon

- Submit the Feedback Survey by Oct 23
- Join Winner Announcements on Oct 28, 7:30 to 9:00 PM IST
- Mark IBM Z Day on Nov 18

Submission video guide: youtu.be/3_L3T__zEco

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Datathon Essentials

IMPORTANT LINKS

- **Participant Guidebook:** docs.google.com/document/d/1tt0Zh…
- **LinuxONE Community Cloud Homepage**
- **Registration in LinuxONE Community Cloud:** linuxone.cloud.marist.edu/#/register?flag=VM
- **Event code (put in project description):** SSF2026
- **Registered user server dashboard:** linuxone.cloud.marist.edu/#/login
- **Instructions:** ibm.biz/BdPcL8
- **Accessing VM with Jupyter Lab ML:** github.com/linuxone-community-cloud/jupyter-lab-ml
- **Jupyter Lab token:** Your_Token
- **LinuxONE Fast Start Guides:** community.ibm.com/zsystems/l1cc/faststart/
- **Get Your LinuxONE Ready (video):** youtube.com/watch?v=y9rZwSq8pw8

DATATHON GUIDELINES – FINAL SUBMISSION ON OCTOBER 17–18

Submission link: hack2skill.com/event/datathon-2026

Don’t know how to submit? Watch the video guide

DISCORD CHANNELS

#announcements
All updates / reminders / links related to the Datathon can be found here

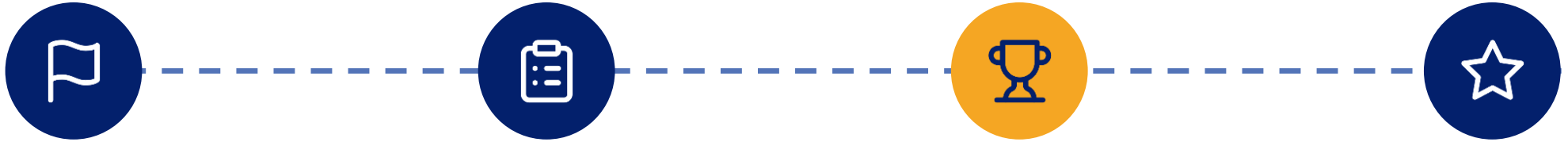
#ibm-z-sme-helpdesk
Ask any question about the Datathon – our IBM Z SMEs are here to help

#helpdesk
General questions – e.g. if you can’t access a document or upload your solution

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Post-Datathon Events

Key dates after you submit – mark your calendars.



Oct 18

10:30 AM IST

Closing Ceremony

Oct 23

Deadline

Submit the Feedback Survey

Oct 28

7:30 – 9:00 PM IST

Winner Announcements

Nov 18

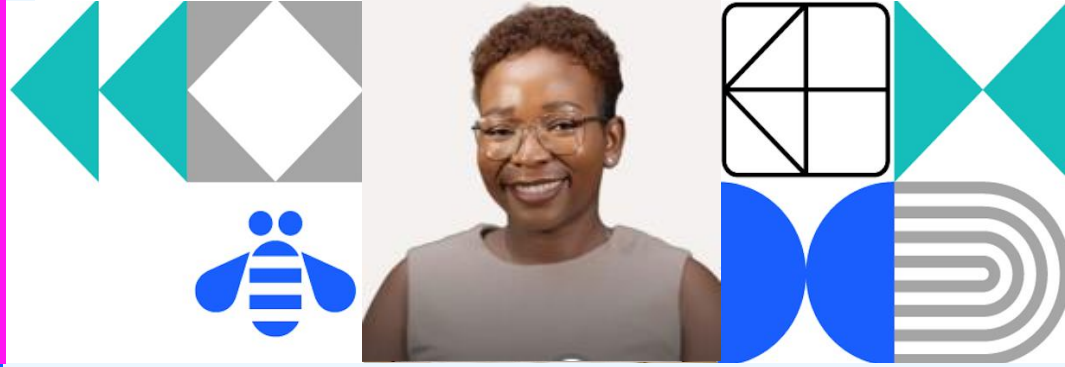
Global celebration

IBM Z Day

//* IBM Z Day
//* open | on | secure

18 November 2026

Register Now



IBM Z's largest tech event of the year is BACK!

IBM Z Makes More Possible: Trusted AI | Cyber Resiliency | Efficient Operations

Don't miss IBM Z Day 2026 on **November 18th from 8:00 AM – 4:30 PM ET** for an exclusive look at the latest innovations from IBM Z and LinuxONE.
Earn 6 industry recognized badges and take your career to new heights.

- **1-DAY** VIRTUAL CONFERENCE– FREE!
- **300+** INDUSTRY SPEAKERS
- **165+** COUNTRIES
- LEARNING PLATFORM **FOR ALL**

Register today: ibm.biz/ibmzday-2026

Dive Into 7 Technical Tracks

- IBM Z
- AI & Data
- App Dev & IT Ops
- Security
- Ecosystem in Action
- IBM Z Skills Acceleration
  Extended 16 ½ hour track (12:00 AM to 4:30 PM ET)
- Asia Pacific Z Day **SE** - Special Edition
  AP time zone (4:30 PM to 4:30 AM ET)

SHOOTING STARS FOUNDATION

LinuxONE Setup & Tech Prep Session Recording

Please review the recording before you start your Datathon



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IT'S TIME TO BUILD

LET THE DATATHON BEGIN!



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IBM Z DATATHON 2026

THANK YOU

For actively participating in the IBM Z Datathon 2026



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